

Problem 5

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Problem 1 Differentiate the following functions:

- (a) Given $f(x) = (x^2 + 4x - 7)e^{-x}$, show $f'(x) = (11 - x^2 - 2x)e^{-x}$.

Explanation.

$$\begin{aligned}
 f'(x) &= \frac{d}{dx} \left(\frac{x^2 + 4x - 7}{e^x} \right) \\
 &= \frac{(2x + 4)e^x - (x^2 + 4x - 7)e^x}{e^{2x}} \\
 &= \frac{e^x(2x + 4 - x^2 - 4x + 7)}{e^{2x}} \\
 &= \frac{11 - x^2 - 2x}{e^x} \\
 &= (11 - x^2 - 2x)e^{-x}
 \end{aligned}$$

- (b) Given $g(x) = \frac{x^2 + 4x - 7}{e^{-x}}$, show $g'(x) = \frac{x^2 + 6x - 3}{e^{-x}}$

Explanation.

$$\begin{aligned}
 g'(x) &= \frac{d}{dx} \left(\frac{x^2 + 4x - 7}{e^{-x}} \right) \\
 &= \frac{d}{dx} \left((x^2 + 4x - 7)e^x \right) \\
 &= \frac{d}{dx} (x^2 + 4x - 7)e^x + (x^2 + 4x - 7) \frac{d}{dx} e^x \\
 &= (2x + 4)e^x + (x^2 + 4x - 7)e^x \\
 &= e^x(2x + 4 + x^2 + 4x - 7) \\
 &= e^x(x^2 + 6x - 3) \\
 &= \frac{x^2 + 6x - 3}{e^{-x}}
 \end{aligned}$$